> **DRAFT — must be reviewed by a registered patent attorney/agent before filing; not legal advice. Public disclosure of these contents may start statutory bars — keep confidential.** This guide is an organizational and drafting aid, not legal advice, and not a substitute for a registered practitioner.
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> **The provisional is ALREADY FILED.** US Provisional Application No. **64/037,173** (Utility—Provisional; Conf. No. 1346; Patent Center No. 75259715) was filed **04/13/2026** and is of record. This guide is therefore reframed: it is no longer about *how to self-file a provisional* but about the **next steps to preserve priority** — chiefly the non-provisional (utility) or PCT conversion. ⏰ **HARD DEADLINE: file the non-provisional / PCT claiming priority to 64/037,173 by ~04/13/2027, or the provisional lapses and the 04/13/2026 priority date is lost.**
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> **Before doing anything in this guide, resolve two facts with counsel:** (1) which post-04/13/2026 new matter (CAS v7.5/7.6/7.7, Fleet/300B) rides on the utility filing vs. needs its own provisional — the original provisional does not retroactively cover it; and (2) the **public-disclosure / offer-for-sale timeline** (NDA spec sheets, the "coming-soon" landing page, the alpha/beta program), which may already have started the one-year U.S. clock and/or barred foreign rights for the utility filing.

Next Steps After the Provisional — Utility-Conversion Working Guide (Updated)

For the CAS Harness mechanisms · prepared 2026-06-08

This is the updated companion to `CAS_provisional_patent_updated.md`. **The provisional (64/037,173) is already filed (04/13/2026)**, so this guide refreshes the legacy `CAS_Self_Filing_Provisional_Guide.pdf` away from "how to self-file a provisional" toward the **next steps that actually matter now**:

- **(a)** file a **non-provisional (utility) application — or a PCT — claiming priority to 64/037,173 by ~04/13/2027** (the binding deadline to keep the 04/13/2026 priority date); and
- **(b)** decide whether to file an **additional provisional** for post-filing new matter (CAS v7.5/7.6/7.7, the Fleet / 300B sharded-audit architecture) that the original provisional does not cover.

The concrete USPTO Patent Center self-filing mechanics below are retained, but aimed at the **utility filing and any new provisional**, against the **current** mechanism set (Evidence Packets, GOVERNANCE-mode WORM anchoring, the Fleet architecture, the three-verdict / six-chip model). It is an organizational and drafting aid — **not legal advice**.

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0. Read this first — the two things the legacy guide got wrong or left stale

1. **The serial number is REAL and the provisional is filed.** Legacy material cites "USPTO Provisional Patent Application #64/037,173," and an earlier internal pass flagged it as suspect on the assumption that U.S. provisionals carry series code **63**. **That assumption was outdated** — U.S. provisional series codes advance over time (60 → 61 → 62 → 63 → **64**), and by 2026 provisionals are **series 64**. The USPTO *Electronic Acknowledgement Receipt* (founder-provided 2026-06-08) confirms **64/037,173** is the real, valid provisional: Utility—Provisional, Conf. No. 1346, Patent Center No. 75259715, filed **04/13/2026**, status received. Do **not** treat it as suspect anywhere. Canonical record: `PATENT_FILING_FACTS_CONFIRMED.md`. **Action:** the binding next step is the **non-provisional/PCT conversion by ~04/13/2027** (§6); also confirm with counsel which post-04/13/2026 new matter needs its own provisional.

2. **The honest scope of the claims.** The product's claim boundaries were deliberately tightened in 2026 (anti-overclaim pass). Anything you file must match: **tamper-evident, not immutable**; **GOVERNANCE-mode, ~30-day rolling retention, operator-overridable** (not COMPLIANCE/permanent); **no standing `ACCEPT`** verdict; **prototype** mechanisms labeled as prototype; **no certification** claims. The draft spec already enforces this — do not let "immutable / permanent / certified / guaranteed / court-admissible" creep back in.

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1. What the filed provisional bought you (and what it did not)

A provisional patent application (PPA) does exactly one job: it **establishes a priority date** for inventions described in enough detail that a skilled person could build them. **64/037,173 did that on 04/13/2026.** What that means now — **[VERIFY all specifics on uspto.gov before the conversion]**:

- **No required claims, no required format.** That flexibility was its advantage and its trap: any mechanism that was **under-described** in the as-filed provisional does **not** get the 04/13/2026 priority date, even though the application was filed. The utility filing should disclose each mechanism fully (replace every `[VERIFY]` in the spec).
- **Not examined; grants no enforceable patent by itself.** Enforceability comes only from converting to a non-provisional and prosecuting it — that conversion is the work this guide now points at.
- **12-month clock, no extension.** The provisional expires 12 months after its filing date. **To keep the priority date, the non-provisional (or a PCT) must be filed by ~04/13/2027.** This is the single binding deadline; calendar it now (§6).
- **"Patent pending."** The technology may be marked patent-pending today, on the strength of 64/037,173.
- **Disclosure is everything.** What the provisional omitted, it cannot confer priority for; and post-04/13/2026 new matter is **not** retroactively covered — it rides on the utility filing or on a fresh provisional.

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2. Costs for the next step (verify on filing day)

The provisional filing fee is already paid. The costs that matter now are the **non-provisional (utility)** filing and any **additional provisional** for new matter. As an independent inventor the applicant likely qualifies as a **micro entity** (largest fee reduction). **[VERIFY on uspto.gov — fees change periodically; the numbers below are indicative only and must be re-confirmed.]**

Item	Micro-entity (indicative)	Notes
Non-provisional (utility) — by ~04/13/2027	**[VERIFY — substantially higher]**	Filing + search + exam. **This is the live budget item.** Plan it now.
Additional provisional (new matter: v7.5/7.6/7.7, Fleet/300B)	**[VERIFY current $]**	Optional; only if counsel routes new matter through a fresh provisional rather than the utility filing.
Micro-entity certification	$0	File the micro-entity certification form **with** the application.
Excess-page fee	$0 under the page threshold	A per-extra-sheet fee applies only above the threshold **[VERIFY threshold and rate]**.
PCT (if pursuing international)	**[VERIFY]**	Defers national-stage costs ~30 months from priority; **[ATTORNEY]** confirm foreign rights survive the disclosure timeline.

Two micro-entity qualification gates to confirm with counsel: (a) a gross-income ceiling **[VERIFY current figure]**, and (b) not having been named inventor on more than the allowed number of prior U.S. non-provisional applications. **[ATTORNEY to confirm eligibility.]**

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3. Try the pro bono / pro se assistance track FIRST (parallel)

Given the cost constraint and the legal complexity here (AI-inventorship, a possibly-already-running disclosure clock, and the priority-preserving conversion of filed provisional 64/037,173), get a **registered practitioner's** eyes on the highest-value mechanisms:

- **USPTO Patent Pro Bono Program** — free volunteer patent-attorney help for inventors under an income threshold (the exact figure varies by regional program). **[VERIFY current threshold and the regional program for the inventor's state.]**

- **USPTO Patent Pro Se Assistance** — guidance resources for self-filers.

Treat the tracks as parallel: finalize `CAS_provisional_patent_updated.md` now so you are conversion-ready, and apply to pro bono at the same time. Even a few hours of real attorney review on Mechanisms A, C, F, and H is worth more than any self-draft — especially to lock the utility-filing scope and the new-matter routing flagged in §0.

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4. What the utility (or new provisional) filing needs (checklist)

Include all of the following so the disclosure is enabling. (This is the same enabling-disclosure bar the provisional was held to; it now governs the non-provisional conversion and any new-matter provisional.)

- [ ] **Title** of the invention. *(Have one in the draft.)*
- [ ] **Field & background** — the technical area and the problem; what was done before and why it was inadequate. *(Drafted: §2–§3.)*
- [ ] **Detailed description** — the core. Each mechanism taught fully enough to build it. *(Drafted: §5.A–§5.I — but every `[VERIFY]` must be replaced with the real value from your code/records.)*
- [ ] **Drawings / flowcharts** — reference each numbered element in the text. Hand-drawn is acceptable if legible. *(See `CAS_provisional_flowcharts_described.md`; formal drawings must be (re)made — the legacy figures are degraded/partly unreadable.)*
- [ ] **Alternative implementations** — variations broaden what the later non-provisional can claim. *(Drafted as "Variations" in each mechanism — extend generously.)*
- [ ] **Example / experimental results** — concrete numbers grounding the disclosure. *(Drafted with `[VERIFY]` placeholders — fill from canonical result files; label offline-validation numbers honestly, never as production/customer results.)*
- [ ] **Inventor information** — full legal name and residence.
- [ ] **Claims** — a non-provisional (unlike the provisional) **requires** at least one claim. §6 of the spec has illustrative claims for counsel to rewrite.
- [ ] **Priority claim** — the non-provisional/PCT must **claim priority to 64/037,173** (and an Application Data Sheet reciting it) to inherit the 04/13/2026 date.
- [ ] **Cover sheet / ADS** + **micro-entity certification** + the fee (provisional cover sheet only if filing an additional new-matter provisional).

Tip on scope: disclose more than your single best implementation. Every genuine alternative you disclose now (different layer indices, probe ranks, cover sizes, model families, anchor backends, fleet-orchestration variants, emission templates) is something your non-provisional may later claim priority for. Omissions are forfeitures.

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5. Filing-strategy decision — one consolidated vs. split (A–G)

[ATTORNEY to decide.] Three options, with tradeoffs:

Option	Pros	Cons
One consolidated utility filing (the updated draft)	Single priority chain across interdependent mechanisms that share the pipeline, Evidence Packet, and integrity chain; one fee; simplest to manage to the ~04/13/2027 deadline.	Pruning a weak mechanism is less clean; one filing for everything.
Split into A–G/H/I (legacy approach)	Spreads cost over time; lets you drop weak mechanisms at conversion; per-mechanism dates.	More filings to track; shared-infrastructure description duplicated; coordination overhead.
Hybrid	File the strongest, most distinctive mechanisms now (e.g., A η→ε bridge, C Evidence Packet, F anchoring gate, H Fleet) as one or two provisionals; defer/prototype-tier ones (I) later.	Requires judgment on which are ripe.

Suggested priority ranking if splitting (carried from the legacy guide, updated): **A** (η→ε bridge — most distinctive) · **C** (Evidence Packet — the deliverable) · **F** (tamper-evident anchoring gate — now a first-class mechanism) · **H** (Fleet — frontier-scale, novel anti-misattribution) · **B** (verification stack) · **D**/**E** (blind-spot / causal localization) · **G** (readiness gate) · **I** (hidden-content — prototype, lowest priority). A PCT later can defer national-stage costs ~30 months from priority if international protection matters. **[ATTORNEY to confirm PCT timing and whether any foreign rights survive the disclosure timeline.]**

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6. Step-by-step: converting 64/037,173 to a non-provisional (current USPTO Patent Center) — verify each step live

> ⏰ **DEADLINE: file the non-provisional (or PCT) claiming priority to 64/037,173 by ~04/13/2027.** Miss it and the provisional lapses and the 04/13/2026 priority date is permanently lost. Calendar it **today** with a ~9-month internal trigger (≈ Jan 2027) to begin drafting.

[VERIFY the exact UI/flow on patentcenter.uspto.gov the day you file; the office updates it.]

1. **Confirm scope first (§0)** — with counsel, settle which post-04/13/2026 new matter (CAS v7.5/7.6/7.7, Fleet/300B) is folded into this utility filing vs. carved into a separate new-matter provisional, and confirm the disclosure-clock status. Do not skip this.
2. **Finalize the spec** — replace every `[VERIFY]` in `CAS_provisional_patent_updated.md` with real values from your code/records; have counsel finalize the **claims** (a non-provisional requires ≥1 claim); remove all bracketed `[ATTORNEY]` notes from the final filed PDF (or keep them only in your working copy). Confirm no prohibited words ("immutable/permanent/certified/guaranteed/court-admissible/COMPLIANCE-mode").
3. **Prepare drawings** — formal figures keyed to the numerals (10, 12, 14, …) used in §5 and re-described in the flowchart doc. Legible is the bar; hand-drawn is acceptable.
4. **Create/Use a USPTO.gov account** with verified identity for Patent Center.
5. **Start a new submission → Nonprovisional (utility) application** (or **PCT**, if pursuing international). Upload the specification PDF (now with claims) and the drawings PDF.
6. **Complete the Application Data Sheet (ADS)** including the **domestic-benefit/priority claim to provisional 64/037,173 (filed 04/13/2026)** — this is what carries the priority date forward — plus inventor legal name + residence, title, correspondence, and entity status.
7. **File the micro-entity certification** with the application (only if counsel confirms eligibility).
8. **Pay the (verified) micro-entity non-provisional fees** (filing + search + examination).
9. **Download and store the filing receipt** for the non-provisional; confirm it correctly reflects the priority claim to 64/037,173. (The provisional's own receipt is

already on file — canonical data in `PATENT_FILING_FACTS_CONFIRMED.md`.)

10. **Re-calendar:** docket prosecution dates for the non-provisional; if a PCT was filed, calendar the ~30-month national-stage deadlines.

*(If instead counsel directs filing an **additional provisional** for the new matter, the flow is the legacy provisional path — new submission → Provisional application, provisional cover sheet, no claims required — but that provisional starts its **own** fresh 12-month clock and does not extend 64/037,173.)*

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7. The four questions at the heart of each mechanism's disclosure

For every mechanism, the draft already answers these; when you fill `[VERIFY]` values, keep answering them concretely — the more concrete, the stronger the priority date. Write as if teaching a competent ML engineer to reproduce it.

- **(a) What it does** — the function, in one or two sentences, then expanded.
- **(b) How it works** — step by step: inputs, the transformation/algorithm, outputs; name every component and how they connect; reference the flowchart numerals. Include the actual procedure (capture positions, map form, template construction, scoring procedure, schema fields, check set, gate predicate, fleet aggregation policy) at the level your code implements.
- **(c) Why existing methods don't do it** — the specific gap this closes that probes / steering / SAE / selective-prediction / WORM-logging / model self-reports do not.
- **(d) Variations and alternatives** — other ways to implement each step (layers, ranks, cover sizes, templates, model families, anchor backends, thresholds, orchestration). List generously.

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8. Honest-disclosure reminders (do not delete these from your process)

- A patent application protects only what it **teaches**, and the non-provisional inherits the 04/13/2026 date **only for matter the provisional already taught**. Trade-secret internals (exact probe construction, fixture design, scoring weights) can be described at a **functional** level while the precise configuration stays out —

but undescribed specifics do **not** get the priority date, and post-04/13/2026 additions get no earlier date than their own filing.
- **Do not overclaim.** "Patent pending" and a priority date are not an examined, enforceable patent. The anchoring mechanism is **tamper-evident**, not immutable. No `ACCEPT` verdict stands. Mechanism I is a **prototype**. Effect-size numbers must match your canonical files and must be labeled offline-validation where that is what they are.
- **Confidentiality.** Until counsel clears the conversion strategy, keep this and the spec confidential; non-NDA disclosure can start or has started statutory bars that bear on the utility/foreign filing.
- **Budget and plan the conversion now.** The non-provisional is the expensive, examined step; the filed provisional was only a placeholder for the 04/13/2026 date, and that placeholder expires ~04/13/2027.

Nothing in this guide is legal advice. Use the pro bono track to get a registered practitioner's review of the highest-value mechanisms and the §0 scope questions well before the ~04/13/2027 conversion deadline.

END — CAS_provisional_filing_guide_updated.md — DRAFT, not legal advice. Keep confidential.